

REPUBLIC OF CAMEROON

Peace-Work-Fatherland

MINISTRY OF HIGHER EDUCATION

NATIONAL COMMITTEE FOR THE ORGANIZATION OF
NATIONAL EXAMS AND COMPETITIVE ENTRANCE
EXAMINATIONS

REPUBLIQUE DU CAMEROON

Paix-Travail-Patrie

MINISTERE DE L'ENSEIGNEMENT SUPERIEUR

COMMISSION NATIONALE D'ORGANISATION
DES EXAMENS NATIONAUX ET CONCOURS

HIGHER NATIONAL DIPLOMA (HND) EXAM

JUNE-JULY 2025 SESSION

Examination Date:

OPTION/ SPECIALTY	ALL
COURSE TITLE	ENGLISH LANGUAGE
TYPE OF EXAMINATION	WRITTEN
COEFFICIENT	1
DURATION	2 HRS

SET 1.

Instructions to Candidates. Answer all question in serial order. Mind your grammar.

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION. (20 marks)

Read the passage below carefully and answer the questions on it selecting from the alternatives A-D.

PASSAGE: BREAST MILK - AN ARSENAL AGAINST ILLNESS

The studies, which go back to the turn of the century, show that nursing the baby definitely prolongs to the period of **natural immunity** to many viral diseases, including mumps, measles, polio, herpes, hepatitis, some kinds of pneumonia, and other respiratory infections. They also show that nursing protects against a number of bacterial diseases. And it has long been known that breastfed babies have fewer problems with diarrhoea than **artificially fed infants**.

With the advent of the 1970s, scientists developed more sophisticated techniques for examining milk, and new information came to light. Thus researchers now know some of the scientific reasons for what the early studies indicated and what many breastfeeding mothers believed all along. The story that is unfolding is more amazing than had ever been imagined. The protective makeup of breast milk reads as though it were taken from a scientist's dream list. Dr. John W. Gerrard, a Canadian researcher, wrote in *Pediatrics* in 1974, "We presumed that the function of breast milk was little more than the provision of **nourishment**. We now know that breast milk also provides effective protection, more effective than antibiotics, against

certain common enteric pathogens, and that it can also be expected to provide relative freedom in infancy from **allergic diseases**, a growing problem of modern feeding habits"

Dr. Herbert Ratner coined a phrase that aptly describes breast milk's unique qualities- "nature's vaccine for the newborn". What the new research also revealed, and what was somewhat of a surprise to many, is that this unique protection starts in high gear, with your baby's first feeding on your colostrums.

The first milk from your breast, which is called colostrums, is low in fat and carbohydrates and high in protein. It is exceptionally easy to digest and is a superb "pick-me-up" for the newborn. In a few days, the thick, creamy-looking colostrum begins to change into thinner, **mature milk**.

Colostrums had been a wallflower in infant nutrition for a time, virtually ignored by many. During the 1970s, researchers began to notice some of its **sterling qualities**. They found it is loaded with living cells that can go to the newborn's defense against a number of potentially harmful agents. Mother's breast, it is now recognized, takes over where the placenta leaves off in protecting the baby.

From early research, it was known that your infant arrives in the world with a supply of antibodies-protective proteins. These come to him from your blood via the placenta. The antibodies, which are also known as immunoglobulin, have been manufactured by your immune system in response to infections that you have been exposed to. These include some of the common contagious diseases of childhood. While the immunity you have to these diseases is lifelong, that which is passed on to your unborn baby gives him temporary protection until his own immune system begins to develop.

In addition, protective antibodies to germs that you have come into contact with in the course of daily living in your home environment also cross over to your baby while he is in the womb.

Research had shown that the calf, unlike the baby, receives no antibodies before birth. Its full, and only, allotment of protective cells comes in the first feeds from the mother cow within hours after birth. As every dairyman knows, the calf that is deprived of colostrum is soon a dead calf. It was also learned that the predominant antibody in this lifesaving colostrum is the immunoglobulin (IgG). When the scientists turned their attention to the baby, it was found that the primary antibody in the baby's cache when he is born is the same antibody. IgG.

The conclusions drawn from these early studies, while not unreasonable, were not quite right either. It was assumed that the transfer of antibodies from mother to baby is a one-time occurrence. Since the important IgG is already present when the baby is born, it was thought that human colostrum was of little importance in the fight against infection. Then along came the advances in technology and suddenly, colostrum, the dispensable, became colostrums the star. It abounds in immunities. Scientists found them in concentrated forms and in new modes that even surpass those acquired by your baby through the placenta.

{coined from New Frontiers English}

QUESTIONS

Answer the following questions by choosing the letter that corresponds to the correct answer from the alternatives A - D. You may be required to provide answers to some questions.

1. Why do you think the writer considers breast milk as an arsenal against illness? (2marks)

- A) It is important
- B) It provides natural immunity
- C) It makes the baby grow stronger
- D) It has sterling qualities

2. The phrase "bottle-fed babies" is a/n (2marks)

- A) noun phrase
- B) adverb phrase
- C) participial phrase
- D) adjective phrase

3. How was the "protective make-up" of breast milk discovered? (2marks)

- A) Through comparative studies
- B) Through scientific innovations.
- C) Through scientific research
- D) In a scientific dream.

4. One of the following is not a characteristic of colostrum. (2marks)

- A) Low protein content
- B) Easy to digest.
- C) Low fat content
- D) Low carbohydrates content.

5. When the writer says that "colostrum had been a wall flower in infant nutrition for a time..." he means that it- (2marks)

- A) has been very vital.
- B) has been neglected for some time.
- C) is very beautiful for the body.
- D) is not very essential to infant nutrition.

6. What provokes the development of antibodies in a woman's system when she is pregnant? (2marks)

- A) Protective proteins.
- B) The placenta.
- C) Contagious diseases.
- D) Her infections.

7. How would "protective antibodies to germs" which an expectant woman contacts in her environment eventually reach the baby in the womb? (2marks)

- A) Through the placenta
- B) Through the immune system
- C) Through environmental factors
- D) Through the mother's food.

8. How is the calf different from a baby as concerns antibodies? (2marks)

- A. the calf deprived from colostrum is soon dead
 - B. protective cells come in the first feeds from mother cow
 - C. the primary antibody in both is the immunoglobulin.
 - D. unlike the baby, the calf does not receive antibodies before birth.
9. Explain how colostrums eventually came to the limelight. (2marks)
- A. a wallflower in infant nutrition for a time
 - B. it was virtually ignored by many
 - C. researchers began to notice its incomparable worth
 - D. it was not until during the 1970s
10. One is not a reason why a breastfed baby likely to enjoy better health than a bottle-fed baby? (2marks)
- A. prolongs the period of natural immunity to viral diseases
 - B. prolongs immunity against respiratory infections
 - C. they have fewer problems than artificially fed infants
 - D. the babies have fewer problems with diarrhoea.

SECTION B: GRAMMAR AND VOCABULARY. (30 marks)

I. Change the sentences below into REPORTED SPEECH: (10 marks)

- 1) "I don't have any lectures today," John said (1 mark)
- 2) "We took our Dad to the park," he said (1 mark)
- 3) "I was at the Supermarket this morning," Paul said (1 mark)
- 4) "We took the car to the garage this morning," John said (1 mark)
- 5) "Mary lived in London two years ago," he said (1 mark)
- 6) "I had a class last week," he argued (1 mark)
- 7) "Yesterday was a very bad day for me," James remarked (1 mark)
- 8) "The little girl wrote a letter to her boss," She replied (1 mark)
- 9) "Tony has a class now," he said (1 mark)
- 10) "Mary doesn't know who her real father is," he argued (1 mark)

II. Copy the sentences below and fill the blanks with the appropriate word from the words in bracket: (10 marks)

- 1) The rain fell for two hours and ____ (seized, ceased, sized ,seeds) (1 mark)
- 2) Martha likes to ____ from classes (dodge , durge, dutch , deutsch) (1 mark)
- 3) Tom used his leg to measure the ____ of the river (deaf , debt , depth , death) (1 mark)
- 4) She was given a ____ for cheating during the exams (not , nut , knot , nought). (1 mark)
- 5) The first term is the first ____ of the academic year (face , farce , phase , phrase)

(1 mark)

6) How ___ you insult me ! (dare , there , dire , dear). (1 mark)

7) My younger sister will help me ___ some plantain (pill , peal , peel , pearl). (1 mark)

8) The speaker ___ a quotation from the popular writer William Shakespeare (sited , sighted , sided , cited) (1 mark)

9) My cat likes to ___ at strangers (stare , stir , steer , stair) (1 mark)

10) I didn't ___ it necessary to inform them of my problems (dim , dream , deem , dime) (1 mark)

III- Fill the spaces on the following table as indicated (10 marks)

Noun	Verb	Adjective
Success	Succeed	Successful
	Justify	
Blood		
		Liberated
	Live	
		Strong

SECTION C: SPOKEN ENGLISH (20 marks)

I-Add tags to the questions below (5 marks)

1. Miriam can take some snacks,? (1mark)
2. The election is not a valid,.....? (1mark)
3. It won't be anything expensive,? (1mark)
4. Joshua should not give his birth-right to Mary,? (1mark)
5. The coast line was very long,? (1mark)

II-Complete the following using indefinite pronouns to make sense (5 marks)

1. students were present at the meeting with the principal (1mark)
2. She talks and attracts the attention of the teacher during lessons (1mark)
3. knows my troubles and trials. (1mark)

4. The elevator cannot take at once. (1mark)

5. The soup needs bit of salt to be tasty. (1mark)

III- Write *a few, a little, much* or *many* to complete these sentences. Do not use *some, any, or a lot of* (10 marks)

1. There's not food in the cupboard. (1mark)

2. She hasn't got friends. (1mark)

3. I'm sorry, I haven't got time. (1mark)

4. The receptionist didn't give me information. (1mark)

5. I can lend you money until tomorrow. (1mark)

6. I asked him to put milk in my coffee.

7. I've seen her times this year, but not very often. (1mark)

8. We only have petrol left. (1mark)

9. She started feeling ill only days before the exam. (1mark)

10. Not people come here in the winter. (1mark)

SECTION D: Writing (30 marks)

Write an essay of about 250 words on any of the following topics

1. How can vocational training contribute to the development of Cameroon.

2. Your sister wants to marry man from another ethnic group against your mother's wish.

Write a letter to your mother giving reasons why she should accept your sister's decision.

3. One the 11th February 2025, the youths in Cameroon celebrated the youth day. Analyse three main points of the speech delivered by the Head of state on the occasion.